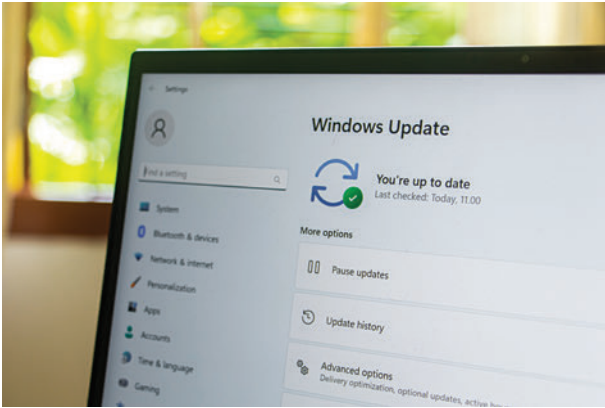




enable automatic updates, ensuring you receive the latest security patches without having to manually check and apply them.

For Windows:

- **Open Settings:** Click on the Start menu and select Settings (the gear icon).
- **Update & Security:** Navigate to Update & Security.
- **Windows Update:** Click on Windows Update, then select Advanced options.
- **Enable Automatic Updates:** Ensure the toggle for “Automatic Updates” is set to On.

For macOS:

- **Open System Preferences:** Click on the Apple menu and select System Preferences.
- **Software Update:** Choose Software Update.
- **Enable Automatic Updates:** Check the box for “Automatically keep my Mac up to date.”

By enabling automatic updates, you can ensure that your devices are always running the latest software versions, minimising the risk of vulnerability exploitation.

Manual Update Checks

While automatic updates cover most needs, occasionally manually checking for updates, especially for critical applications and firmware, is essential. This ensures that no updates have been missed and that your software is always up to date.

How to Manually Check for Updates:

- **Windows and macOS:** Both systems provide a manual check feature within their update settings. For Windows, navigate to Windows Update and click “Check for updates.” On macOS, in the Software Update pane, click “Update Now” if any updates are available.
- **Applications:** Most applications have an “About” or “Check for Updates” option in their menus, where you can manually initiate an update check.

Regularly checking for and applying updates is a key practice in maintaining device security and ensuring the integrity of your digital activities.

The Importance of Antivirus and Anti-Malware Software

Antivirus and anti-malware software are your digital immune system, actively scanning for and removing malicious software that could compromise your device’s security or personal data.

Understanding Antivirus and Anti-Malware

While the terms are often used interchangeably, antivirus software traditionally focuses on classic viruses, and anti-malware software addresses a broader range of malicious software, including spyware, ransomware, and adware. Modern solutions typically combine both functionalities to provide comprehensive protection.



Selecting the Right Software

Choosing the right antivirus and anti-malware software depends on several factors, including detection rates, system impact, and user interface. Opt for software that offers:

- **High Detection Rates:** Look for independent lab test results online to find software with high rates of malware detection.
- **Lightweight:** The software should not significantly slow down your device.
- **Real-Time Protection:** Choose solutions that monitor your system in real time, rather than just on-demand scans.

Regular Scans and Updates

To maximise the effectiveness of your antivirus and anti-malware software, it’s crucial to keep it updated with the latest malware definitions and regularly scan your system.

Setting Up Regular Scans:

- **Open Your Antivirus Software:** Navigate to the main dashboard.
- **Schedule Scans:** Look for a settings or configuration option where you can schedule regular scans. Opt for a frequency that balances security with system performance, such as weekly.
- **Scan Types:** Most software offers different types of scans (quick, full, custom). A weekly full scan is recommended for thorough protection.